



PRACTICE PLAN

SHORT GAME TRAINING
PROGRAM

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The plan below has been put separated into experimental, calibration, performance and transference training types.

For all measurements, get a piece of string tied around a tent peg. Make coloured markings on the string to mark out 3 ft, 5ft, 8ft, 10ft, 15ft, 25ft. When measuring, place the tee in the ground next to the hole and then stretch out the string. You could also just “eyeball it” if you aren’t overly obsessed.



These drills are designed to open up and push the boundaries of your skills. Pick one or two drills in each area to work on, try to vary it each time to stay fresh. For all of the drills, where possible, keep track of the weekly averages as a %.

Putting Drills

Short putt face control (differential)

- Set 3 shots up on a 6ft putt – one straight, one right to left and one left to right.
- Alternate each time
- Round one, set up with the clubface square to intended start line
- Round two, set up with the clubface open to the intended start line
- Round three, set up with the clubface closed to the intended start line
- This is 9 balls total – hit the tenth ball on the straight putt with a square face
- Repeat this drill, adding in more variation – for example hitting every single ball with a different clubface start line.
- See how extreme you can have the face offline and still hole the putt

Short putt face control (variability drill)

- Set up 3 shots on a 6 ft putt – one straight, one right to left and one left to right
- Alternate each time – always keeping your clubface aligned to your intended start line
- Hit one putt with your feet square, one with your feet open, and one with feet closed
- Alternate it each time, so you essentially hit each putt with a different combination, totaling 9 putts.
- Hit the last ball (tenth) with your feet square to a straight putt.

Short putt speed

- Set up 3 shots on a 6 ft putt – one straight, one right to left and one left to right
- Alternate each time – always keeping your clubface aligned to your intended start line
- Vary the speed each time, hitting one with a hard rap (fast speed), one with a medium pace, and die one into the hole softly.
- Each of the three putts should be hit with all 3 speed – never hit the same speed twice
- Last putt (tenth ball), hit with your preferred speed on the flat putt

Lag putt drill- wristy/dead hands

- Hit 10 putts towards a hole 35 feet (10 yards) away
 - Putt 1 = normal
 - Putt 2 = use more wrist action and less arm action
 - Putt 3 = use dead hands (less wrist action, more arm action)
 - Putt 4 = grip the club as tight as possible
 - Putt 5 = grip the club as loose as possible
 - Repeat for a total of 10 balls
- See how many you can get within a 3ft circle of the hole
- Repeat the drill as many times as you can and get a weekly average
- If your weekly average is more than 70%, repeat the drill but vary between a 30 foot and a 40 foot putt

Lag putt tempo

- Set up a 30 foot, 40 foot and 50 foot putt
- Set a metronome to 40 bmp and hit a putt from each area
- Set a metronome to 80 bmp and hit a putt from each area
- Set a metronome to your desired tempo, hit a putt from each area
- Hit the last putt from 20 feet away
- Measure how many get within a 3ft radius of the hole

Chipping Drills

Face Strike (differential)

- Set up a standard chip shot from 10 yards, 20 yards and 30 yard
- Hit 3 shots from each, varying between striking the middle, heel or toe of the club each time (still on the grooved part of the face, just toe or heel biased)
- This will equal 9 shots – hit the tenth from the middle of the club from 20 yards
- Score 1pt for within 8ft, and 2 pts for within 4 ft of the hole

Ground Strike (differential)

- Set up a standard chip shot from 10 yards, 20 yards and 30 yard
- Hit 3 shots from each, varying between striking the ground
 - Ball/turf contact, as crisp as possible
 - 1 -2 inches behind the ball
 - 3-4 inches behind the ball
 - It doesn't matter if you get it exact, as long as this is your attempt
- This will equal 9 shots – hit the with a normal ground strike from 20 yards
- Score 1pt for within 8ft, and 2 pts for within 4 ft of the hole

Chipping Technique change

- Hit 10 chips from either 20 yards or 30 yards
 - Chip 1 = normal
 - Chip 2 = use more wrist action and less arm action
 - Chip 3 = as stiff wristed action as possible
 - Chip 4 = grip the club as tight as possible
 - Chip 5 = grip the club as loose as possible
 - Repeat for a total of 10 balls
- Score 1 pt for within 8 ft, 2 pts for within 4 ft
- Vary the shot distance each time

Chipping trajectory (Variability)

- Set up a chip from 10, 20 and 30 yards – hit 3 balls from each
- Vary between a higher, lower and mid trajectory
- Never hit the same shot twice
- Make sure to do each trajectory from each distance, totaling 9 balls
- Hit the last shot from 20 yards with your desired trajectory
- Score 1pt for inside 8 ft, 2 pts for inside 4ft

Pitching Drills

If possible, use launch monitor data – much of these drills are similar to the chipping ones, just adjusted for pitching. If you cannot do the full distances, simply repeat the shorter distances until you get the required number of shots – it is more important that you have a score that you can improve with time.

Face Strike (differential)

- Set up a standard Pitch shot from 40 yards, 60 yards and 80 yard
- Hit 3 shots from each, varying between striking the middle, heel or toe of the club each time (still on the grooved part of the face, just toe or heel biased)
- This will equal 9 shots – hit the tenth from the middle of the club from 60 yards
- Score 1pt for within 12ft, and 2 pts for within 6 ft of the hole

Pitching trajectory (Variability)

- Set up a Pitch from 40, 60, 80, 100 and 120 yards
- Vary between a higher, lower and mid trajectory
- Never hit the same shot twice
- Make sure to do each trajectory twice from each distance, totaling 30 balls
- Score 1pt for inside 12 ft, 2 pts for inside 6ft

Divot Depth

- Set up a Pitch from 40, 60, 80, 100 and 120 yards
- Vary between a deep divot, medium divot and a picked shot (no divot)
- Never hit the same shot twice
- Make sure to do each divot style twice from each distance, totaling 30 balls
- Score 1pt for inside 12 ft, 2 pts for inside 6ft

Pitching Tempo

- Set up a Pitch from 40, 60, 80, 100 and 120 yards
- Use a metronome on your phone (earphones) - Vary between a 40bmp, 80bmp and a desired tempo
- Do two rounds with each tempo, totaling 30 balls
- Make sure to do each divot style twice from each distance, totaling 30 balls
- Score 1pt for inside 12 ft, 2 pts for inside 6ft

Pitching varying start position

- Set up a Pitch from 40, 60, 80, 100 and 120 yards
- Vary the start position of your clubhead between normal, hovering 6 inches above the ground, or starting 6 inches behind the ball on the ground (like Moe norman)
- Do two rounds with each start position
- Make sure to do each start position twice from each distance, totaling 30 balls
- Score 1pt for inside 12 ft, 2 pts for inside 6ft

Bunker Drills

Ground Strike (differential)

- Choose a standard bunker shot
- Hit
 - 3 shots, entering the sand very close to the ball
 - 3 shots, entering the sand a long way behind the ball
 - 3 shots, entering the sand in between

You determine what is a long way behind the ball, as some sand types will react differently. The main thing is that you are experimenting with different entry points. See if you can adjust the other variables (speed, open/closed face, depth of divot etc) to make each entry point work.

Divot Depth (differential)

Similar to the above game, but with a larger focus on how deep you go into the sand.

- Choose a standard bunker shot
- Hit
 - 3 shots with a deep divot
 - 3 shots with a shallow cut of sand
 - 3 shots with a middle depth divot

Try to adjust the other variables (entry point into the sand, face open/closed, speed etc) to make each divot depth work.

Ground Strike (variability 27 shots)

- Choose a standard bunker shot
- Hit 3 shots with each variation of
 - Ball middle of stance (deep, middle and shallow divot)
 - Ball forward in stance (deep, middle and shallow divot)
 - Ball back in stance (deep, middle and shallow)

CALIBRATION



TRAINING

This type of training is designed to get back to equilibrium and start honing in on a desired technique.

Pitching

- Play two pitch shots from 40, 60, 80, 100 and 120
- Note down what the biggest problem with each shot was (strike with ground, strike with face, speed or face direction)
- When you find the predominant fault (e.g. face strike), go into an improvement phase where you isolate that component. Hit 10-20 shots increasing your focus on face strike mainly, until you get it where you deem fit. Repeat the process.
- See the Pitching calibration sheet in the worksheets file

Chipping

- Play ten chips from various situations
- Note down what the biggest problem with each shot was (strike with ground, strike with face, speed or face direction) using the chipping calibration sheet in the worksheets file.
- When you find the predominant fault (e.g. face strike), go into an improvement phase where you isolate that component. Hit 10-20 shots increasing your focus on face strike mainly, until you get it where you deem fit. Repeat the process

Lag Putting

Attempt a neutral (standard) technique. Hit longer lag putts – note down if the predominant fault was speed, start direction or read. Based on the predominant fault, isolate that area and do the following drills

Speed faults – Start 3 yards away from the hole. If you successfully putt within 3ft from the hole, move back a yard. Continue until you reach 15 yards away from the hole. Then repeat with the goal being 2ft from the hole for a successful putt.

Start direction faults - place a tee in the ground on a small slope. Play 3 different putts to this tee from 5 feet. Do one directly uphill (straight putt) and 2 from side-hill lies.

Reading – pick a different shot each time. Go through a full routine and work out the line of the putt. Keep hitting shots until you get the speed as desired (this may take one shot or 20), then note down on a piece of paper whether you missed high or low. Repeat for a new scenario.

Short putting

Attempt varying putts of around 6ft. Note down when you miss a putt what the issue was (speed/read or start line). Refer to the short putting calibration table in the worksheets file.

When an issue reaches a frequency of 10, do the following

Start line issues – putt to a 1 euro/quarter coin from 5 foot until you hit it 10 times

Speed issues – place 2 alignment sticks 1-2 inches apart. Try to roll the ball so it jumps the first alignment stick and finishes between the two

Read issues - note down if the miss is predominantly low or high. Find a 6ft breaking putt, place a club on the low side (for low side faults) and play a game where you get 1 point for holing, minus a point for hitting the stick and nothing for missing high. Reverse this if your predominant miss is high side

PERFORMANCE



TRAINING

With all of these tests, you will quickly figure out what does and what doesn't work. Try to stick with something and continue to test it, even if it doesn't work initially. However, feel free to discard some of the foci from your testing should you deem it impossible. E.g. in chipping, I absolutely hate focusing on the landing area, so I don't bother testing it anymore personally.

Lag Putting

The ladder drill

- Start 3 yards from the hole.
- If you get the ball successfully within 3 ft of the hole, go back a yard
- Continue going backwards until you miss a putt (don't get it within 3 ft)
- Note down how far back you got in yards
- Test different attentional foci and see which one you perform consistently better with

Foci to test

Focus 1 = Tempo - put a metronome at your desired tempo. Focus on making the swing at the same tempo as the beat.

Focus 2 = Breathing – take one look at the hole while breathing in. Bring your eyes back, breathe out smoothly and putt at the same time (make sure you start breathing before you start putting)

Focus 3 = External narrow – focus on the hole only, try to mentally lock in on it and visualize the ball rolling at the right speed into the cup

Focus 4 = External wide - Imagine a 3ft big hole around the ball (dustbin lid) and try to ease the ball into that area

Short Putting

When inside your scoring range, you may decide that a different focus of attention improves your performance. This will test a short putt focus

Short putt test

- Place 10 putts around a hole so you get a mixture of curves and uphill/downhill putts.
- set 5 putts from 4 ft
- set 5 putts from 6 ft
- Do all of the putts with a singular focus, note your score, then re-test with a different focus.
- Repeat as necessary – the more data you can collect the more reliable

Foci to test

Focus 1 = Tempo - put a metronome at your desired tempo

Focus 2 = Breathing – take one look at the hole while breathing in. Bring your eyes back, breathe out smoothly and putt at the same time (make sure you start breathing before you start putting)

Focus 3 = External narrow – focus on a small part of the back of the cup

Focus 4 = External wide - focus on the whole hole

Focus 5 = Technical - something you are working on in your technique

Chipping Performance

Different lies and shots will need different focuses, but you can still test for these if you have enough time.

Chipping test

- Place 10 balls around the green in varying lies with varying shots
- Stick with one focus for each round, then re-test with a different focus
- Test the following foci

Foci to test

Focus 1 = **External (target awareness - hole)**

Focus 2 = **Breathing – make practice swings looking at the hole. Take a deep breath in, breathe out and chip as you are breathing.**

Focus 3 = **One internal technical cue of your choice (weight/shaft lean/wrist movement)**

Focus 4 = **Quality of ground strike**

Focus 5 = **External target awareness (landing zone)**

Scoring

Distance from pin	Score
In the hole	20
0-3ft	10
3-5ft	8.7
5-10ft	5.5
10-15ft	3
15-25ft	1.5

See which focus you score the most points with – use this focus for your transference games

Pitching Performance

Pitching test

- Play a 2 shot from 40, 60, 80, 100 and 120 yards (10 balls total)
- Stick with one focus for each round, then re-test with a different focus
- Test the following foci

Foci to test

Focus 1 = Tempo - put a metronome at your desired tempo

Focus 2 = Breathing – make practice swings looking at the hole. Take a deep breath in, breathe out and chip as you are breathing.

Focus 3 = External narrow – focus tightly on the hole

Focus 4 = External wide - focus on the general landing area

Focus 5 = Technical - something you are working on in your technique

Focus 6 = Focus on ground strike

Scoring

Distance from pin	Score
0 -5ft	9.5
5-10ft	5.5
10-15ft	3
15-25ft	1.5
25ft +	0.5
Missed green	-1.5

See which focus you score the most points with – use this in the transference stage

TRANSFERENCE



TRAINING

The main goal of transference training is to create game based situations where you can test retaining your performance focuses.

These games should also be recorded so you can aim to beat them each week and try to induce self pressure and increase engagement during practice

Rather than re-iterate them here, the main games I would like you to play would be the ones in the **performance phase**. However, rather than varying foci and testing, simply stick with your dominant focus and try to improve your scores.

However, in order to mix it up every now and again, try the below games.

Seal the deal

I wrote this article for Golf State of mind – I will link you to it here – it is a great game

<http://golfstateofmind.com/seal-deal-better-putting/>

18 hole putting tournament

Play 18 holes on the putting green selecting 6 long, 6 short and 6 mid length putts. Keep a scorecard and repeat as necessary

Par 36

Select 6 easy, 6 middle and 6 difficult up and down shots. Play the chip shot and putt out as if a real miniature golf hole. Keep score, with par being 2 for each hole.

Worst Ball

Do one of the above games in a worst-ball format

Best ball

Do one of the above in a best-ball (2 ball scramble) format – hit 2 balls and pick the best one, then repeat until holed out.

In a row

Stand over a 5 foot putt and block practice. See how many shots you can hole in a row. Start again and re-set to 0 when you miss one.

Chipping seal the deal

Chip from 15 yards. A successful level is complete when you hit one ball long of the cup, one ball short and one in between – AND the distance between front and back ball is 20 feet or less. Move back 5 yards as you complete the level. Go back a level after 3 failed attempts.

Short game Assault Course

Start with 10 balls, the aim is to get as many balls through to the next round. You complete the level when you have got at least one ball through all 5 rounds.

Level	TASK			
	Lag Putt	Pitch shot	Chip	Short Putt
1	30ft, within 2 putter lengths	30 yards, within 20 ft from hole	15 yard shot to within 3 club-lengths	3 foot putt
2	30ft, within 2 putter lengths	30 yards, within 20 ft from hole	20 yard shot to within 3 club-lengths	3 foot putt
3	40ft within 2 putter lengths	30 yards, within 20 ft from hole	25 yard shot to within 3 club-lengths	4 foot putt
4	40ft within 2 putter lengths	40 yards within 20 ft from hole	15 yard shot to within 2 club-length	4 foot putt
5	50 foot within 2 putter lengths	40 yards within 20 ft from hole	20 yard shot to within 2 club-length	4 foot putt
6	30ft within 1 putter length	50 yards within 20 ft from hole	20 yard shot to within 2 club-length	5 foot putt
7	30ft within 1 putter length	50 yards within 20 ft from hole	20 yard shot to within 2 club-length	5 foot putt
8	40 foot within 1 putter length	30 yards within 10 ft from hole	20 yard shot to within 2 club-length	5 foot putt
9	40 foot within 1 putter length	30 yards within 10 ft from hole	20 yard shot to within 2 club-length	6 foot putt
10	50 foot within 1 putter length	40 yards within 10 ft from hole	25 yard shot to within 2 club-length	6 foot putt
11	50 foot within 1 putter length	40 yards within 10 ft from hole	25 yard shot to within 2 club-length	6 foot putt
12	40ft within a shaft length	50 yards within 10 ft from hole	25 yard shot to within 2 club-length	6 foot putt
13	40ft within a shaft length	50 yards within 10 ft from hole	25 yard shot to within 1 club-length from hole	6 foot putt
14	50ft within a shaft length	40 yards within 6 ft from hole	25 yard shot to within 1 club-length from hole	8 foot putt
15	50ft within a shaft length	50 yards within 6 ft from hole	30 yard shot to within 1 club-length from hole	10 foot putt

For example, you are on level 7.

- You hit 10 lag putts from 30ft, 7 are successfully within 1 putter length.
- You then hit 7 pitch shots from 50 yards, of which 5 are successfully within 20 ft
- You then hit 5 chip shots from 20 yards, 3 of which are successfully within 1 club length
- With the remaining 3 balls, you hole 1 putt from 5ft.
- You have passed the level and go onto level 8.